AB 1599 Kickoff Meeting

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The meeting focused on launching implementation of AB 1599, which requires creation of a statewide transit stop registry with unique stop identifiers and associated stop amenity information. Participants discussed project scope, deliverables, technology options, data governance, stakeholder engagement, identifier design, and project management needs. The group emphasized that this is a significant undertaking requiring a structured work plan, regular coordination, and collaboration with transit agencies statewide.

Key Points

Legislative Requirements

AB 1599 requires development of a statewide transit stop registry that includes:

- A unique identifier for each transit stop.
- Stop location information.
- Shelter availability.
- Seating availability.

The legislation establishes a June 2027 deadline for the initial registry. A subsequent phase will involve broader transit agency adoption and integration.

Existing Work and Data Foundations

Current efforts include:

- Development of processes to identify shared stops across agencies.
- Identification of location discrepancies and data quality issues.
- Collection of stop amenity data beyond minimum legislative requirements.
- Creation of algorithms to cluster nearby stop locations and identify likely duplicate records.
- Use of California's existing transit stops dataset as an initial foundation.

Participants acknowledged that the current statewide stop dataset is a useful distribution tool but remains a largely aggregated dataset with significant inconsistencies that must be resolved.

Registry Design and Technology Discussion

Several implementation concepts were discussed:

The registry will ultimately feed a public-facing statewide dataset. However, an internal staging and management environment will be needed first to allow data validation, correction, and maintenance before publication.

Key technology questions remain unresolved:

- Where the registry should be hosted.
- What database and front-end tools should be used.
- How agencies will submit and update information.
- How data will be staged, reviewed, and published.

A model similar to Norway's transit stop registry was discussed, where agencies maintain their own records through an online portal. Participants noted that California lacks the same level of statutory authority to compel participation.

Unique Identifier Strategy

The group discussed several approaches for statewide stop identifiers:

- Simple auto-incrementing numeric identifiers.
- Human-readable identifiers incorporating geographic information.
- County-, district-, or highway-network-based references.
- Identifier schemes that support both operational and planning uses.

No final decision was made. Participants agreed that identifier design requires additional discussion and consultation with transit agencies.

Stakeholders and Users

Potential users of the registry include:

- Transit agencies.
- Transit planners.
- Maintenance and asset management staff.
- Corridor planning teams.
- Customer success and agency support staff.
- Local public works departments.
- Mapping and mobility platforms.
- Accessibility and disability communities.
- Developers using public data.

The group emphasized that a common statewide stop identifier would improve coordination across agencies, planning efforts, asset management programs, and public-facing applications.

Transit Agency Outreach

Agency engagement will be a major project component.

Discussion focused on:

- Collecting stop amenity information.
- Validating duplicate and shared stop records.
- Resolving disagreements on stop locations.
- Incorporating transit operator input into registry design.
- Leveraging existing agency relationship management structures.

Regional planning organizations and MPOs may be included where appropriate to support outreach and coordination.

Data Quality and Long-Term Vision

Participants acknowledged that achieving highly precise stop locations statewide will be a long-term effort. The immediate objective is to establish consistent identifiers and substantially improve location consistency, while creating a framework that can support future asset management and infrastructure programs.

Next Steps

- Develop a formal project work plan with milestones, deliverables, timelines, and responsibilities.

- Establish recurring project meetings on a weekly basis.
- Add additional staff involved in related transit asset and stop infrastructure work to future discussions.
- Begin planning a statewide stop amenity data collection campaign.
- Determine where collected amenity data will be stored, managed, and validated.
- Continue evaluating technology architecture, database structure, and user access models.
- Refine options for the statewide stop identifier scheme.
- Prepare material that can support a forthcoming AB 1599 implementation plan and legislative reporting requirements.

Action Items

- Create a project management work plan with schedule, milestones, deliverables, and ownership assignments.
- Schedule recurring weekly implementation meetings.
- Develop an outreach strategy and campaign for collecting stop amenity data from transit agencies.
- Define the data collection process, including response formats and storage locations.
- Document and evaluate potential identifier naming conventions.
- Assess technology platforms for registry development, staging, and publication.
- Compile grouped stop datasets and duplicate stop records to support future agency coordination and validation efforts.
- Develop content that can be incorporated into the formal AB 1599 implementation plan.